Vests Until Verified - New-Hire Safety Program

Purpose: reduce first-90-day incidents by visually identifying new hires so the whole floor can guide and protect them.

THE RULE

- All new hires (direct AND temp agency) wear a hi-vis vest from DAY ONE, issued at orientation.
- The vest stays on until the employee is brought on full time (converted from temp, ~90 days).
- The supervisor performs the sign-off to release the vest when the employee converts.

WHAT THE VEST MEANS (message to the floor)

"The vest means 'look out for this person.' They are new and learning. Give them grace, guide them, and flag anything they miss. It is not a punishment - it is everyone agreeing to protect them."

WHY THIS MATTERS (data backing)

- Our 2026 data: 100% of temp-agency incidents are employees under 3 months.
- 48% of all incidents happen in the first 3 months; 68% in the first 6.
- Since all production starts as agency and converts at ~90 days, the vest covers the exact risk window.
- Low cost (hi-vis Class 2 vests ~$5-15 ea) vs. the cost of one recordable.

TIMELINE / ROLLOUT

- **Phase 1 - Pilot on one shift first (Matt's) to work out the kinks.**
- **Phase 2 - Roll out to all shifts and both sites.**
- **Ongoing - Introduce the vest at orientation going forward, so every new hire starts with it.**

AGENCY COORDINATION

- EXPRESS: notified - on board with day-one vests at orientation.
- KSS: TO NOTIFY - align on the same day-one rule.

WHO DOES WHAT

- **EHS (Justin) - EHS: procures vests, runs orientation briefing, provides the weekly safety topic.**
- **Supervisor - Supervisors: issue vests at orientation, sign off release when employee converts, lead the morning safety talk.**
- **Agencies - Temp agencies (Express/KSS): ensure temps arrive ready to receive a vest and understand the program.**